Daniel Rodriguez

Senior iOS Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior iOS engineer with 13+ years of full-time iOS experience and a 16-year career across mobile and games. Architecturally-minded IC who has shipped consumer apps as the sole iOS engineer at multiple companies, most recently taking a SwiftUI app from zero to the App Store in under a year as Founding iOS Engineer at Adapter Group. Earlier work includes AR architecture at Warby Parker, whose app serves 2.4M+ active customers, and a BAFTA-winning title at FreshPlanet. Expertise in Swift, SwiftUI, and Swift Concurrency, with a production AI-native development workflow built around Claude Code. Continuing to ship indie apps to the App Store. Bilingual (English / Spanish).

EXPERIENCE

Founding iOS Engineer

Adapter Group — New York, NY · December 2024 – March 2026

- Sole iOS engineer on a consumer app built in SwiftUI and Swift Concurrency, shipping to TestFlight in about four months and to the App Store inside a year.
- Proposed and won approval for the app's architecture when a React Native rewrite was on the table, keeping the product on native iOS with a progressive path to convert the highest-value surfaces to SwiftUI, connected by a type-safe TypeScript to Swift bridge.
- Architected the app's foundation: Auth0 authentication with universal link handling, deep linking, push notifications, and a custom SwiftUI component library with Rive-powered animations, plus a real-time AI assistant interface built on SSE streaming and async/await, and a light and dark color system implemented ahead of the design spec.
- Stood up the team's CI/CD pipeline, App Store Connect submission process, and TestFlight distribution from scratch, then migrated from Xcode Cloud to GitHub Actions, cutting build times and eliminating a recurring monthly cost.
- Pioneered an AI-native development workflow (Claude Code, Warp.dev, Git worktrees for multi-agent feature work), demonstrating that a single engineer could deliver a production-grade consumer app at startup pace.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS & AR

Warby Parker — New York, NY · July 2021 – October 2024

- Shipped iOS features for Warby Parker's consumer app, which serves 2.4M+ active customers and was featured by Apple on the App Store. Ran contrast audits and added Dynamic Type support across consumer surfaces.
- Led the architectural redesign of the consumer app's AR experiences during the SceneKit→RealityKit migration: virtual glasses try-on with face tracking, glasses removal, and branded Easter eggs (including a Spider-Man 2 PS5 launch tie-in).
- Extracted the AR/3D feature into a standalone Swift framework, enabling reuse across multiple internal and consumer surfaces.
- Built an internal iPadOS tool consuming that framework, letting the design team load GLTF 3D models from Files or Google Drive and preview them directly in the AR experience, bypassing the existing asset pipeline entirely. Shipped and adopted as the standard internal preview tool.
- Built a separate internal iPadOS measurements app from scratch using Apple Vision frameworks, deployed across all 270+ Warby Parker retail locations nationwide.
- Assigned by engineering leadership to mentor a junior engineer through their first feature, retaining delivery accountability while they owned the implementation. Shipped on schedule.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS

Zipari — New York, NY · September 2020 – July 2021

- Built and maintained member-facing iOS features for a consumer health insurance platform, working with protected health information under HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Shipped from a single codebase white-labeled across multiple insurance carriers, with per-carrier theming and configuration.
- Introduced sprint planning and standups to the mobile team's delivery process, adapted from practices at Paperless Post.

Independent iOS Developer

Independent — New York, NY · 2019 – Present

- **KiteCalc** (2026, ongoing) — Solo-shipped an iOS app for kiteboarding gear calculations, available on the App Store. Built in Swift/SwiftUI for iOS 26. Calculation engine open-sourced as KiteboardingKit at github.com/dornad/KiteboardingKit
- **Repe.app** (2026) — Collectible sticker album web game engine. SvelteKit, TypeScript, Vercel. IP-agnostic engine with runtime content switching, lz-string collection sync, and feature flag system.

• **Global Game Jam** — Unbroken annual streak since 2019. Eight games shipped from scratch in 48-hour sessions using Godot and Unity.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS

Paperless Post — New York, NY · July 2015 – June 2020

• Core iOS engineer for five years, owning development and maintenance of the consumer app through its Objective-C to Swift transition.
• Mentored a team of 5–10 mobile engineers, guiding best practices and code quality across the platform.
• Ran technical interview rounds for mobile hires, designing each round around the individual candidate, running take-homes and live coding sessions, and presenting findings in hiring debriefs.
• Point person for establishing the team's Swift style guide, forked from the New York Times Swift Style Guide, and a first-line reviewer on pull requests against it.
• Helped codify the team's Swift conventions into a shared style guide the mobile team built against.
• Led yearly adoption of new Apple platform features, keeping the app competitive at each iOS release.

EARLY CAREER

Lead Mobile Game Engineer — HOMER Learning (2014–2015)

Sole mobile engineer (reporting to CTO) on an iPad game teaching children to read. Shipped features on monthly release cycles.

Lead Software Engineer — AnyoneGame / Just Sing It (2013–2014)

Sole engineer for a social karaoke app with 200K+ users. Took two apps from concept to App Store, marking the pivot from game development into iOS engineering.

Technical Lead & Game Programmer — FreshPlanet / Gameloft (2010–2013)

Shipped multiple social and mobile games on Facebook Canvas, iOS, and Android, including SongPop (100M+ players, BAFTA Best Online Game 2013). Built Adobe AIR Native Extensions in Objective-C and Java.

Overseas Faculty — Carnegie Mellon University (2010)

Co-taught Building Virtual Worlds at Universidad de Monterrey (UDEM), Mexico, guiding student teams through a series of rapid virtual-world prototypes.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Master of Entertainment Technology · 2008 – 2009
Entertainment Technology Center (ETC) — interdisciplinary program for game design, interactive media, and entertainment technology. Alumni include game developers at Disney, Pixar, Naughty Dog and Electronic Arts.

Sketch-It-Up! — Publication: Bulut Karakaya, Camilo Garcia, Daniel Rodriguez, Manoj Nityanandam, Nadia Labeikovsky and Theyab Al-Tamimi. "Sketch-It-Up! Demo", Lecture Notes in Computer Science: Entertainment Computing – ICEC 2009 (2009): 313–14.

Universidad de los Andes — Bogotá, Colombia

B.Sc., Computer and Software Engineering · Focus: Real-time computer graphics

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Swift · Objective-C · TypeScript · GDScript

iOS Frameworks: SwiftUI · UIKit · Combine · Swift Concurrency (async/await) · ARKit · RealityKit · SceneKit · Metal · TCA · Point Free Dependencies · XCTest · Swift Testing · WebKit / WKWebView

Mobile Engineering: Push Notifications · Universal Links · Deep Linking · Auth0 / OAuth · Keychain · MVVM · Accessibility / HIG · REST APIs · SSE · Feature Flags (PostHog, OpenFeature, ConfigCat)

Tooling & CI/CD: Xcode · Instruments · Swift Package Manager · Fastlane · Xcode Cloud · GitHub Actions · TestFlight · App Store Connect · Git · Zed · VSCode · Claude Code · OpenCode · Warp.dev

Game Engines: Godot · Unity

Spoken Languages: English (native) · Spanish (native / bilingual)